2026-11-01 — שיר של יום, אתה הראת, and the Origins of the Haftarah — Or Zarua, Soferim, and the Greek Decree

Content-based review · checked against the PRIMARY Sofer.ai transcript (no timestamps, so passages are cited by quoted phrase, shown as [“…”]) · the Plaud transcript (this time with no usable speaker labels: every line is “Speaker 1”) and summary were used only as secondary checks · reviewer also read the final Sefaria-corrected English write-up and the Sefaria log entry for this date · 1 November 2026 · 21 Cheshvan 5787 · reviewed on the final (Sefaria-corrected) draft; the shiur HTML was not edited, so every correction below is a recommendation

1.The Shiur in One Paragraph

A Sunday-morning shiur on the Shabbos morning service, opened with a dedication (breakfast sponsored by a friend of the shul for his mother’s yahrzeit, מרים בת חיים יצחק). The Rav finishes Shacharis with the שיר של יום and asks why Ashkenazim say it after Musaf when the Levites sang it with the morning תמיד: the Magen Avraham finds the Ashkenazic custom illogical, the Aruch HaShulchan asks why the Musaf song is not said, the Magen Avraham explains why there is no song after Mincha (the libation could fall after שקיעה), and Nitra and the Young Israel of Woodmere (Rabbi Billet, for decorum) moved it earlier. He turns to taking out the Torah: the Simchas Torah sale of הוצאת ספר תורה (Or Zarua), giving פתיחה to a man whose wife is in her ninth month (Chida, מנהג ותיקין) and to a חתן; *Masechet Soferim* as the ancient minhagim of Eretz Yisrael, with its very long series of verses; the Or Zarua’s dream (the verse אור זרוע לצדיק and עקיבה / עקיבא in a גט), the Rhineland custom of reciting nothing, and the Shibbolei HaLeket’s family, the four families exiled to Rome, and Rav Avraham the doctor who revived the Soferim verses. אתה הראת (Tur 281, a Spanish custom) and ויהי בנסע הארן follow. Then the מי שברך after each aliyah (“for money”; בעבור שיתן מתנה; the warning on unpaid vows; the Beis Yosef’s ברכה versus תפילה for the sick). The

longest part is the haftarah, the “very radical machloket”: Rashi in Sefer HaPardes (a chapter of Prophets every day, lapsed because רבתה העניות; later haftaros for the day, the chasan, the Rambam, Rav Sherira) against the Avudraham (a Greek decree; twenty-one verses), with Elijah Levita’s Sefer HaTishbi (Antiochus) and the Levush (no Kesuvim), an excursus on teaching Torah to non-Jews, and three questions from the room (the triennial cycle and Benjamin of Tudela; why seven aliyos; מחר חודש).

2.Overall Fidelity — What the Write-Up Does Well

- **The Sofer.ai text is followed over the Plaud wherever they differ.** Plaud’s “nighter,” “Udmur,” “Leo Bacher,” “the Lubavitcher” (for the Levush), “Rabbi Yonba Chai,” “Arba Chayim,” “Rabbi Zviel David” and the summary’s “Rav Drum” are all correctly not carried over; the HTML has Nitra, Woodmere, Eliyahu Bachur, the Levush, the Avudraham and (in the Plaud summary’s place) the Sofer’s אור זרוע. The Plaud summary’s “[Insert Name]” header and its “assignments” (a decorum committee, a study sheet, consulting Rabbi Langer) are correctly not carried over.
- **The architecture is faithful and proportioned.** The eight sections follow the live order closely: dedication and the שיר של יום; the ark; Soferim, the Or Zarua and the Roman families; אתה הראת; the מי שברך; Rashi; the Avudraham, Levita and the Levush; the room’s questions. The one reordering is VIII, where three questions that were put in the middle of the Avudraham passage are collected at the end (see Section 3, Flag 5); the move is sensible but not disclosed.
- **The Rav’s hedges mostly survive.** “I don’t know if they read two chapters a day,” “I suspect that Rashi is quoting a מנהג that was before the Gemara,” “I don’t have a good answer; the Magen Avraham doesn’t like it,” “קען זיין” on the chasan, and “maybe bad things happened as a result of it, it’s very hard to tell” on Levita are all kept. The Rav’s own errors (the Rambam’s yahrzeit “somewhere in Shevat,” בבל corrected to

Rome for the exile, “daf צ”) are reported without being put right in his mouth, and corrected in the notes.

- **Tangents that would embarrass the Rav are left out.** The Cuomo remark about who may attend a shiur, the greeting of Rav Shaul HaKohen, the roll-call for the sponsor’s mother’s name, the sponsor’s name, and the Hebrew letters of Rabbi Billet’s name are all properly omitted or kept in a note.

- **The corrections to the Rav’s citations are reported without being put in his mouth.** Shabbos 32b (not Nedarim), Menachos 99b (not daf צ), the Tur at 281 (confirmed from the Plaud summary), the Rambam’s 20 Tevet, and the Rema passage that could not be found are all in the notes; the Sefaria log (fn1 through fn25) matches the HTML note for note.

- **Sofer-over-Plaud choices checked and confirmed.** Every Sofer reading used in the HTML is the better one where the two disagree (see Section 4).

- **The header date is right.** 1 November 2026 is 21 Cheshvan 5787 (14 Cheshvan was 25 October).

3.Content Flags — What Is Wrong, Mis-Attributed, Omitted, or Added in the Final Draft

Everything below was tested against the Sofer text. The Plaud transcript for this recording labels every line “Speaker 1,” so it cannot settle who is speaking; attributions here rest on the Sofer wording and context. None of these has been applied; they are the recommended corrections of Section 5.

> **Flag 1 — The logic of the inference about “before the Gemara” is broken by the list (VI).** The HTML gives Rashi’s five-part list as מקרא, נביא, משנה, תא וגמרא and then says the Rav “suspects Rashi is quoting a custom from before the Gemara was even written, which would explain why he lists

תלמוד, ברייתא, משנה, [illegible] together." In the Sofer the inference is: ["I suspect that [illegible]" is quoting a [illegible]ג that was before the [illegible]א was written [illegible]ל', so he spoke about משנה, נביאים וכתובים, מקרא, [illegible]נה and [illegible]תא"]. The Rav's second list has *no* Gemara, which is exactly why he says the custom predates it; the first list (["[illegible]רא ... נביא ... משנה ... ברייתא, גמרא"]) is ambiguous (Plaud: "Brisa Gemara"), and his walk-through in fact fulfils only mikra, mishnah, beraisa and navi. The HTML reads a Gemara into the inference that the Rav has just removed. Fix: give the list as the Rav does, note that the first mention of "[illegible]תא גמרא" is unclear, and make the inference "Rashi's list has no Gemara, so the custom may be older than the Gemara."

Flag 2 — The non-Jews exchange is softened and partly mis-assigned (VII). The HTML: "Another congregant raises the Rambam's [illegible]ולא שבט לוי בלבד אלא כל [illegible]ו ואיש, wondering whether that includes non-Jews; the Rav answers that it does not and cites [illegible]דרין דף נ"ט.ז" In the Sofer: ["Yeah, it could be it's including [illegible] also, the [illegible]ם"ב says... That's what I heard once. Wow! Don't say that ever publicly again."], then ["What's with the [illegible]א in [illegible]סנהדרין דף [illegible]ו, you're not allowed to teach [illegible]תורה? Wow, [illegible]ג עצום. Okay, makes sense."]. The Rav's reaction to the Rambam point is alarm ("don't say that ever publicly again"), not a reasoned answer, and the Sanhedrin 59a objection is put as a question in the room that the Rav accepts; he does not cite it himself. The next line, ["These people became even bigger Christians"], is the Rav's own (the Plaud agrees). Fix: either give the reaction faithfully ("the Rav: 'Wow! Don't say that ever publicly again.'") or, better for the book, drop the Rambam exchange and keep only the Igros Moshe and Sanhedrin 59a, in the Rav's voice.

Flag 3 — The Sefardic-shul question is the Rav's, not a participant's (VI). The HTML (Haftaros that match the day): "A participant asks what would happen in a big Sefardic shul with a [illegible] every week." The Sofer: ["You do it? So you don't read the [illegible]רה of that week? What if there's a [illegible] every single week in [illegible], in a big [illegible]דישע שול־? They don't [illegible]ן the [illegible]רה? You hear this?"]. The speaker is the Rav, addressing the room (and apparently a Sefardi member, since he later says "we don't even do what [illegible]דן says they do by the [illegible]דים־"). Only the "[illegible]שרה, the [illegible]זה of [illegible]וכים" is a participant's joke (the Rav: "don't be a wise guy!... very good"). Fix: give the first question to the Rav and say that Reb Dan informed him that the Sefardim do it.

Flag 4 — The girl's blessing is a voice from the room (II). The HTML puts in the Rav's practice: "…and if it's a girl, that she should marry a תלמיד חכם." The Sofer: ["or if it's a girl, it's going to be a girl that should, you know, whatever. I don't know what you say by a girl. Okay. Yeah, to marry a תלמיד חכם. Okay."]. The Rav said he does not know what to say for a girl; someone supplied the words and he agreed. Fix: "…for a girl, the Rav is not sure what to say; a participant suggests that she marry a תלמיד חכם."

Flag 5 — Three interruptions have been moved out of the middle of the Avudraham (VII, VIII) and one point is lost. In the Sofer the order is: the Avudraham's decree and the twenty-one verses; a voice from the room (["Yes, we spoke about it yesterday, שלש סעודות"]); ["there's different מנהגים on exactly where to end… but you have to have at least 21 פסוקים, מה שאין כן בטוב, when the יום is shorter, when there's less פסוקים, you have to have less פסוקים"]; Reb Berel's triennial question; Benjamin of Tudela; the seven-aliyos question; ר' חודש; and then, ["Oh, we'll get to that in a moment… I want to say the other opinion. The other opinion was that it was a decree… according to the דרכם, there was never a יום to יום הפטרה every day like יו"ט"]. The HTML collects the questions into VIII, which reads as a clean list, but it (a) does not say it has moved them, and (b) drops the Yom Tov point (fewer aliyos, fewer verses), which is the Rav's own confirmation of the 3 × 7 logic and answers the Editorial Review's question about why the number of aliyos fixes the verse count. The Plaud summary has the Yom Tov point. Fix: restore it in VII, and keep the VIII reordering with a one-line note. If the sentence about "yesterday at Shalosh Seudos, the haftarah of Parshas…" is ever restored, the correct parsha is וירא (Plaud "Vayero"); the Sofer's א is a mis-hearing.

Flag 6 — ר' חודש: the HTML moves "not like our minhag" to the wrong clause (VIII). The HTML: "According to many מנהגים, you read מחר ליין ש only when Shabbos is ראש חודש (Sunday being ש חודש), and when Shabbos is itself ש חודש, 'not like our מנהגנו,' we read the haftarah of ש חודש." The Sofer: ["according to a lot of מנהגים, you ליין מחר חודש only when it's ראש חודש ת and Sunday is ש חודש, not like our מנהגנו. Our מנהגנו is we when ראש חודש ת, we the תורה of ראש ש, not ר חודש."]. The Rav's first sentence is itself garbled ("Shabbos

Rosh Chodesh and Sunday Rosh Chodesh" is probably "Shabbos erev Rosh Chodesh"), and the "not like our minhag" follows it. The HTML has tidied the Rav's sentence into something he did not say. Fix: report the garble ("the recording is unclear here") or say only what is clear: our practice reads the Rosh Chodesh haftarah when Shabbos is Rosh Chodesh, and the Magen Avraham raises the חודש ר question.

Flag 7 — The Musaf-song answer is guessed (I). The HTML: "Someone offers an answer, and the Rav points out that *Masechet Soferim*... spells out the songs for every Musaf... 'Every time there's a Musaf, they say, now we can learn Torah' is how the Rav (somewhat tongue in cheek) summarizes the point." The Sofer: ["The ך השלחן has no answer. Anybody has an answer? Yes, we do! Very good question, . If you look in כת סופרים at the back... every time there's a ף, they say, 'Oh, now, now we can learn יישר כח '. ה. As our ג is, we take a 60-second pause"]. Nobody offers an answer in the text; the Rav himself says "Yes, we do," complimenting Nasan's question, and points to Soferim. The fragment "now we can learn Torah" is unintelligible (it may be the Rav's joke about the break). The HTML invents a summary that the Rav did not give. Fix: "the Rav answers that Soferim, at the back of Avodah Zarah, spells out the songs of every Musaf (Rosh Chodesh, Shabbos, Yom Tov, Shavuos, Sukkos, Pesach)"; drop the "now we can learn Torah" gloss or flag it as unclear. Note 3 already reports that the chapter in Soferim was not retrieved.

Tension A — Who said "Europe added ודים (III). The HTML says "in Europe, a participant notes, they added עינים ,אלפים , ים and אוזים." The Sofer: ["Sometimes, sometimes it could be both. I don't remember what... Correct, correct, like in Europe, in Europe they added ד and ש and ש and ש yeah. You should know it's not within the scope of the עיון ש"]. The words after "Correct, correct" are the Rav's, continuing from a participant's remark about names in gittin (the "ט״ק of note 9); the participant's contribution is the part the recording does not carry. Recommend: "the Rav agrees with a remark from the room, and adds that in Europe they added ודים."

Tension B — "This morning" and "just now" (I, VI). The Woodmere story is introduced with "I just learned this now" after someone beside him told him

(the Plaud has a name, garbled): the HTML says the Rav “shares something he ‘just learned this morning’.” The Rambam / ark haftarah is the one he says he found *this morning* ([“I only found it out this morning”]). Minor; correct the first to “just now.”

Tension C — Antiochus was supplied (VII). The Sofer has the Rav begin [“ בחור אליהו says that in the times of נבוכדנצר ו, I think... no, no, yeah, יון , אנטיוכוס , מלכות יון thank you”]; the Plaud has the same. The Rav does not remember who the king was and someone supplies the name. The HTML states “ מלכות יון in the days of אנטיוכוס without qualification; since this is the answer to the section’s question, it should read “as the Rav relays Eliyahu Bachur.” The Rav’s own wording (“Eliyahu Bachur says…”) is kept; the point is only that the name was prompted.

Tension D — “Bnei Bavel” and the triennial cycle (VIII). The Sofer and the Plaud agree that the Rav (and Reb Berel’s question) says [“the מנהג של בני בבל the תורה every three years”], and the Plaud summary repeats “Bavel.” The HTML is faithful to the recording. But the triennial cycle was Eretz Yisrael’s, and the Cairo shul in the very next sentence is the “ancient minhag.” This is the Rav’s slip or a mishearing. For the Sefer Edition, put it right in the body and ask the Rav.

Smaller points. (a) The sponsor’s name (שמואל פרוינד) is omitted, which is right for a book but should be kept in the editorial file; the Plaud has “Reb Shmuel Freund,” confirming it. (b) The HTML says the Rav “jokes about his own outstanding balance”; the Sofer: [“I owe I owe some money to the , שול אקע What's the נישט א געשעפט ? מ׳נעמ It is closer to a pointed joke at the gabbai’s expense than a confession; the Sefer should drop it. (c) The Rav’s name for the Shibbolei author ([“ אברהם בן צדקי I think צדקיהו בן אברהם אפא ר׳]) is a hesitant hearing and the HTML correctly puts it in quotation marks. (d) The question “what’s the קורס for someone whose wife is in the ninth month?” and the Chida are as the Sofer has them; the Plaud summary’s “Rabbi Avraham ben Tzidkiyah (father of the Shibbolei HaLeket)” as a co-advocate with the Or Zarua differs from the Sofer (Rav Avraham alone, in Rome), and the HTML follows the Sofer. (e) The “Torah is not in heaven” rejoinder after the Or Zarua’s dream is a participant’s and is kept as such. (f) The closing “ חג

ושמח כשר (“a kosher and happy holiday”) at the end of the Sofer has no holiday in this week’s calendar; the HTML omits it, correctly flagged in the Sefaria log.

4.Sofer vs. Plaud (Resolved), Remaining Garbles, and the Mareh Mekomos

Sofer-vs-Plaud differences that are resolved (the HTML already follows the Sofer in every row marked “yes”):

Item	Plaud	Sofer.ai	HTML
Sponsor / mother	“Reb Shmuel Freund”; “Miriam, Matzvahim Yitzchok”	רב שמואל פרוינד; מרים בת חיים יצחק	**yes (name of mother kept)**
Shul in Borough Park	“nighter”	נייטרא	**yes**
Woodmere	“Udmur”; informant garbled	Young Israel of Woodmere; Rabbi Billet	**yes (note 4)**
Or Zarua’s author	“Rabbi Yitzchok Meremoshia”	רבינו יצחק בר משה of Vienna	**yes**
Rabbi Moshe Langer’s father	“Rabbi Zviel David”	רב ישראל דוד	**yes (not named in the body)**
Author of	“Leo Bacher,”	אליהו בחור /	**yes**

the Tishbi	“Rebillio Bachur”	Elijah Levita	
Who cites the decree	“the Arba Chayim,” “the Lubavitcher”	Eliyahu Bachur; the לבוש	**yes**
Source of the 21 verses	summary: “Rav Drum”	אבודרהם	**yes (log note)**
Menachos daf	“Afzadik”	“daf צ”	**yes, corrected to 99b**
Tur siman	summary: 281	רפ״א	**yes (note 12)**
Haftarah “yesterday”	“Vayero”	“וארא”	not in HTML; the Plaud is right (Vayera was Shabbos 31 October)
Haftarah of the chasan	“Sos Asis” in summary	שוש אשיש	**yes**
Who is speaking	every line “Speaker 1”	unlabelled	no (Flags 2, 3, 4, 7)
Which Rav Avraham	summary: “Rabbi Avraham ben Tzidkiyah, father of the Shibbolei”	רב אברהם הרופא, father of the author	**yes (note 11)**

Garbles the Sofer does not resolve (the write-up stays hedged or should).

(1) The “now we can learn Torah” fragment after Soferim and the Musaf songs

(Flag 7). (2) The Rav's שמור חודש sentence (Flag 6). (3) The reply to Rav Nasan about the Musaf song: "הכי נמי, but the question is we should additionally say the one by Musaf, but I hear." (4) Whether the "Reb Berel" triennial question said ומל ישראל (Tension D). (5) The Rav's "six (the Rav first says seven)" missed Barchu recitations (it is not clear how the arithmetic works). (6) Who told the Rav about Rabbi Billet. (7) The names of the fourth family of the exiled four. (8) What the Rav means by "Yes, we spoke about it yesterday."

Is the apparatus honest? Yes, and it matches the Sefaria log. The notes separate "the Rav said" from "the editor identified"; the verified notes (1, 3, 8 for the verse, 12, 13, 17, 20 for the Rema, 22 for Sanhedrin 59a, 24) are tied to specific texts; the corrected notes (14, 17) leave the Rav's words alone; and the unresolved notes say so. Items worth strengthening: note 2 (the Magen Avraham's actual text, which as retrieved says the song is said after both Shacharis and Musaf, contradicts the body's "the Magen Avraham holds that the Sefardic way is correct"; the body should be hedged); note 14 (the Rav calls the vow passage "the Gemara in Nedarim" and, in the same breath, "the Midrash"); note 18 (the Rema glosses do not mention שש אשיש so the body's "the Rema brings" is the Rav's claim only); note 19 (the Rambam died in Egypt; the Rav says Eretz Yisrael; the date in the note is editorial); note 21 (the Tishbi was printed in Isny in 1541 and is not "rare"; keep the Rav's words but flag); and note 25.

5.Recommended Corrections for the Sefer Edition

None of these has been applied to the shiur HTML (the file was not edited for this review). Locators are phrases from the Sofer.ai transcript.

1. **Section I:** replace "Someone offers an answer" with the Rav's own "Yes, we do" and drop the invented summary of the "now we can learn Torah" fragment (Flag 7). Hedge "the Magen Avraham holds the Sefardic way is correct" against note 2.
2. **Section II:** give "marry a תלמיד חכם" to the voice from the room (Flag 4); change "just learned this morning" to "just now" for Woodmere

(Tension B).

3. **Section III:** give the “Europe added יודים” line to the Rav (Tension A); print the letters of the verse (ר-ע-ק-י-ב-ה) and not “רבי עקיבא.”
4. **Section VI:** repair Rashi’s list and the “before the Gemara” inference (Flag 1); give the Sefardic-shul question to the Rav (Flag 3); move “Haftaros that match the day” out from under “First view: Rashi,” since the Rav himself folds it back into “the שיטה of Rashi” only loosely.
5. **Section VII:** restore the Yom Tov point (fewer aliyos, fewer verses) as support for the 3 × 7 (Flag 5); hedge the Antiochus identification (Tension C); fix or drop the Rambam / Sanhedrin attribution (Flag 2).
6. **Section VIII:** say that these questions were asked during the Avudraham passage; correct בבל to ארץ ישראל in the body with a pointer to the Rav’s wording (Tension D); mark the מחר חודש sentence as unclear (Flag 6).
7. **Sefer Edition (open):** drop the roster of names (Reb Nasan, Reb Berel, Reb Dan, Reb Yehuda, the gabbai, Rabbi Billet’s decorum committee), the Beis Yeshayah joke, the balance joke, the kiddush club, the Sefardic-shul quips and the teaching-gentiles excursus; keep the Rav’s sources, the Rashi / Avudraham contrast and his hedges.
8. **Keep the existing honest flags unchanged** (notes 2, 5, 6, 14, 17, 19, 21).

6.Follow-up Questions Worth Asking the Rav, and Bottom Line

Q1.What did the Rav mean by “Yes, we do” and “now we can learn Torah” after Soferim and the Musaf songs: is the Musaf song answered by Soferim, and which chapter?

Q2.Where does the Magen Avraham say the Ashkenazic custom “does not make sense,” given that the text retrieved has both after Shacharis and after Musaf? And where does the Aruch HaShulchan ask about the Musaf song?

Q3.Where does the Or Zarua tell the dream of the verse אור זרוע לצדיק and which Or Zarua passage says the Rhineland said nothing when taking out the Torah? Who is the “professor in Eretz Yisrael” whose book on Soferim the Rav is reading?

Q4.Who revived the Soferim verses, the Or Zarua or Rav Avraham the doctor in Rome? What was the fourth of the exiled families?

Q5.Where does Rashi / the Sefer HaPardes say what the Rav reports, and does the list include Gemara? Where are the Rema’s chasan haftarah, the Rambam’s and Rav Sherira’s haftaros, and the Avudraham’s and Levush’s words on the decree and on Kesuvim?

Q6.Did the Rav mean מנהגי בבל or מנהגי ארץ ישראל for the three-year cycle? How does the arithmetic of six missed Barchu recitations work?

Q7.Does the Rav stand by publishing the exchange about teaching Torah to non-Jews, the Rambam’s הלא שבט לוי בלבד and Igros Moshe? Which volume of the Igros Moshe?

Against the Sofer.ai transcript, the final write-up is a faithful, carefully hedged account of a long and sprawling shiur. Its errors are few and local: Rashi’s list and the “before the Gemara” inference are tangled (the Rav’s second list has no Gemara), the Rambam / Sanhedrin exchange on teaching non-Jews is softened and partly mis-assigned, three lines are given to a participant that are the Rav’s (the Sefardic-shul question, the “Europe added ז” line) or to the Rav that came from the room (the blessing for a girl), the Musaf-song answer and the מחר חודש sentence are tidied into something the Rav did not say, and the Yom Tov point that supports the 3 × 7 logic is lost. What stays open is research, not transcription: the Magen Avraham, the Pardes, the Rema’s chasan haftarah, the Avudraham and Levush wording, the Rambam and Rav Sherira haftaros, the triennial-cycle slip, and every Or Zarua and Shibbolei HaLeket detail.

Produced by a content-based review pass — checked against the primary

Sofer.ai transcript, with the Plaud transcript and summary as secondary sources, the current English write-up, and the Sefaria log entry. Complement to the Independent Editorial Review.